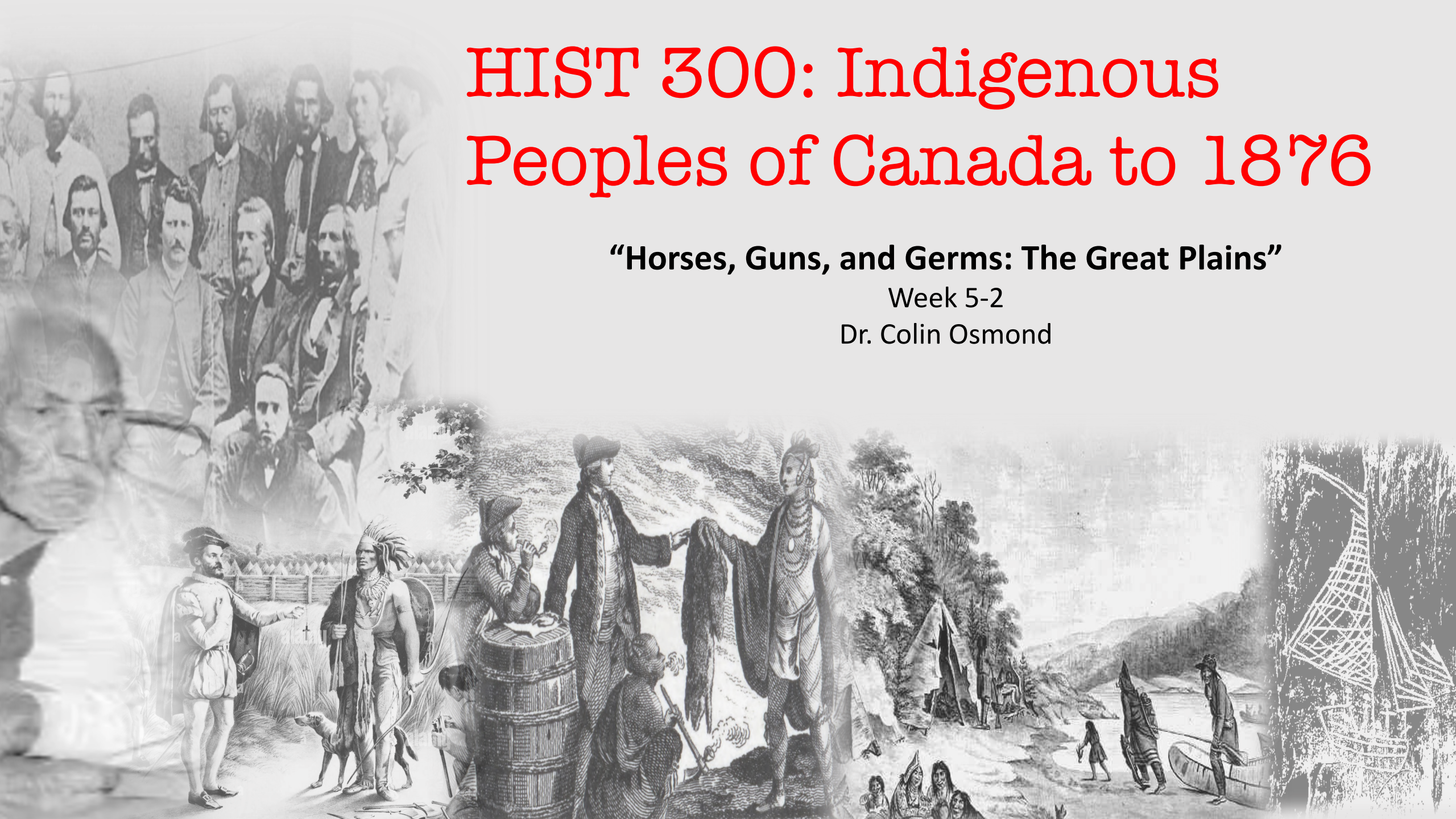
HIST 300: Indigenous Peoples of Canada to 1876

“Horses, Guns, and Germs: The Great Plains”

Week 5-2

Dr. Colin Osmond



Recap:

- End of Seven Years' War – Beginning of American Revolution
- France had lost New France – Britain now claimed most of eastern North America
- Indigenous people caught in another European/Settler conflict
- Creation of the United States sparked massive migration to what is now Canada – the Loyalists
- After the War of Independence – Indigenous people begin to lose their places as key military allies

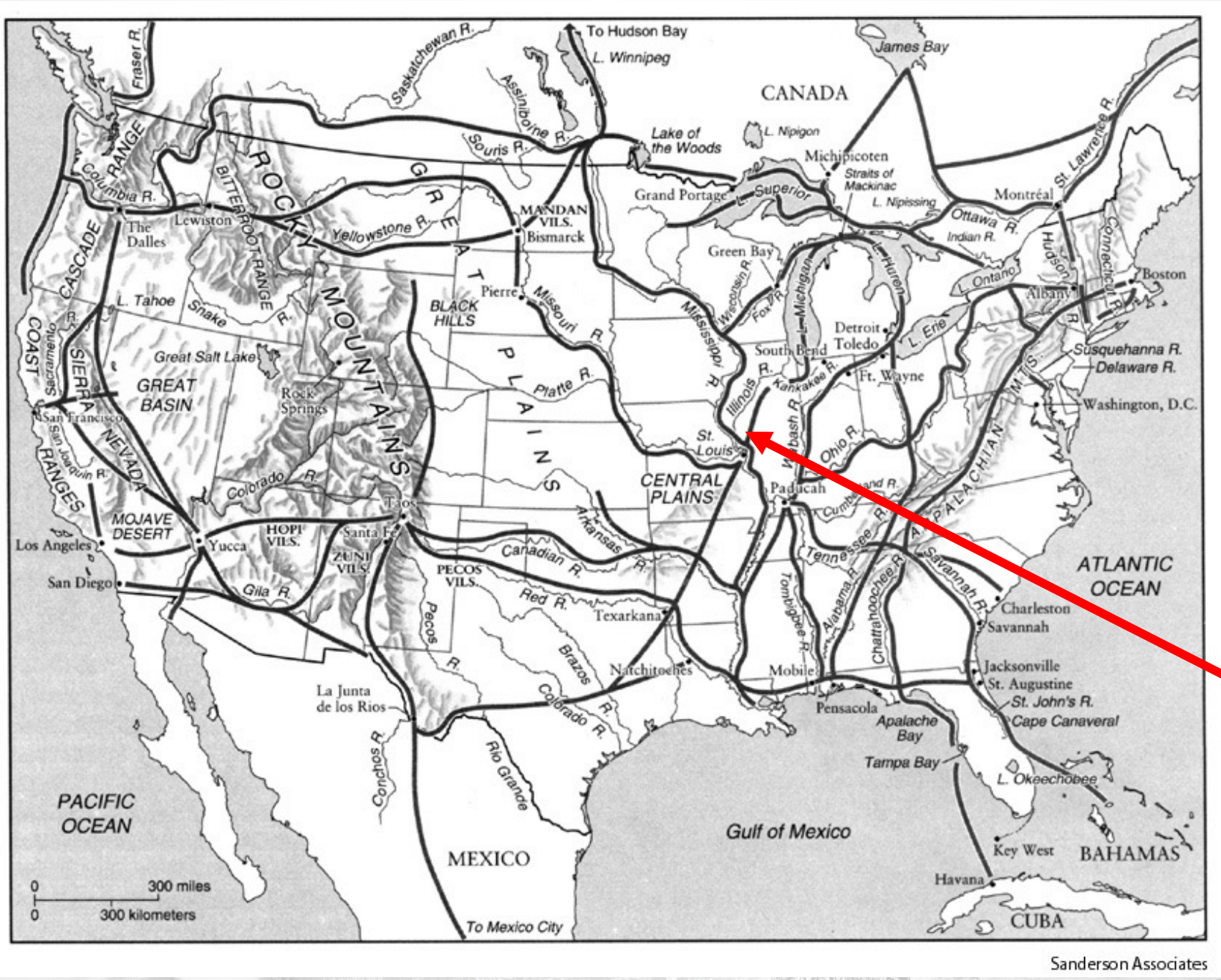
Learning Outcomes/Keywords

- Indigenous History on “The Great Plains”
- Challenge stereotypes – “Ecological Indian”
- The Great Plains were a landscape of change, conquest, warfare, and mass resource harvesting
- Indigenous Empires – centered on bison, powered by horses and guns
- Bison populations boomed in 14-15th century – but were all but destroyed by the late 19th century
- *Keywords: Bison, buffalo jumps/pounds, Comanche, Horses, Guns, Iron Confederacy, Fur Trade, Pemmican, Sioux, Cree, Anishinaabe, Hudson’s Bay Company, Northwest Company*

The Myth of the Untouched Wilderness

- Settlers could not acknowledge Indigenous land use at the same time they were taking the land
- Not a “Terra Nullius” – it was a landscape changed by massive epidemics
- “The Ecological Indian”
  - Not using nature - a part OF nature.
  - An “other” to Industrial Europeans



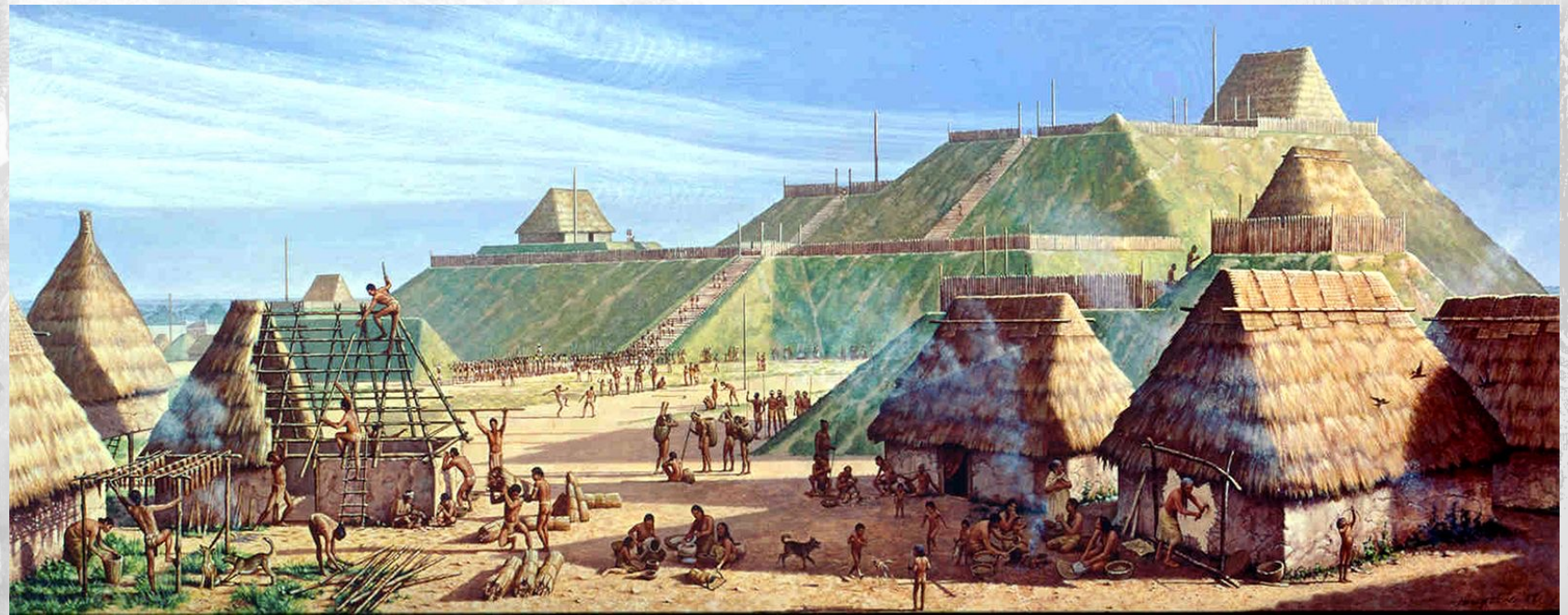

To Hudson Bay
L. Winnipeg
CANADA
James Bay
Fraser R.
Saskatchewan R.
Assiniboine R.
Souris R.
Lake of the Woods
L. Nipigon
Michipicoten
Straits of Mackinac
L. Nipissing
Grand Portage
L. Superior
Montréal
St. Lawrence R.
Ottawa R.
Indian R.
Hudson R.
Connecticut R.
Boston
Albany
Columbia R.
CASCADE RANGE
ROCKY MOUNTAINS
BITTERROOT RANGE
Lewiston
The Dalles
Yellowstone R.
MANDAN VILS.
Bismarck
GREAT PLAINS
Pierre
Missouri R.
BLACK HILLS
Green Bay
Wisconsin R.
Fox R.
Michigan
L. Huron
Ontario
Detroit
Toledo
L. Erie
South Bend
Kankakee R.
Ft. Wayne
Susquehanna R.
Delaware R.
Washington, D.C.
L. Tahoe
Snake R.
Great Salt Lake
GREAT BASIN
Rock Springs
Platte R.
Mississippi R.
Illinois R.
Wabash R.
St. Louis
Ohio R.
Paducah
Cumberland R.
Tennessee R.
APPALACHIAN MTS.
Sacramento R.
COAST RANGES
SIERRA NEVADA
San Francisco
San Joaquin R.
Colorado R.
Taos
Santa Fe
HOPI VILS.
ZUNI VILS.
Arkansas R.
CENTRAL PLAINS
MOJAVE DESERT
Yucca
Los Angeles
San Diego
Gila R.
Canadian R.
PECOS VILS.
Red R.
Texarkana
Pecos R.
Brazos R.
Natchitoches
Mobile
Tombigbee R.
Alabama R.
Chattahoochee R.
Savannah R.
ATLANTIC OCEAN
Charleston
Savannah
Jacksonville
St. Augustine
St. John's R.
Cape Canaveral
La Junta de los Rios
Conchos R.
Rio Grande
Colorado R.
Pensacola
Apalache Bay
Tampa Bay
L. Okeechobee
PACIFIC OCEAN
Gulf of Mexico
MEXICO
Key West
BAHAMAS
Havana
CUBA
To Mexico City
0 300 miles
0 300 kilometers
Sanderson Associates

Cahokia

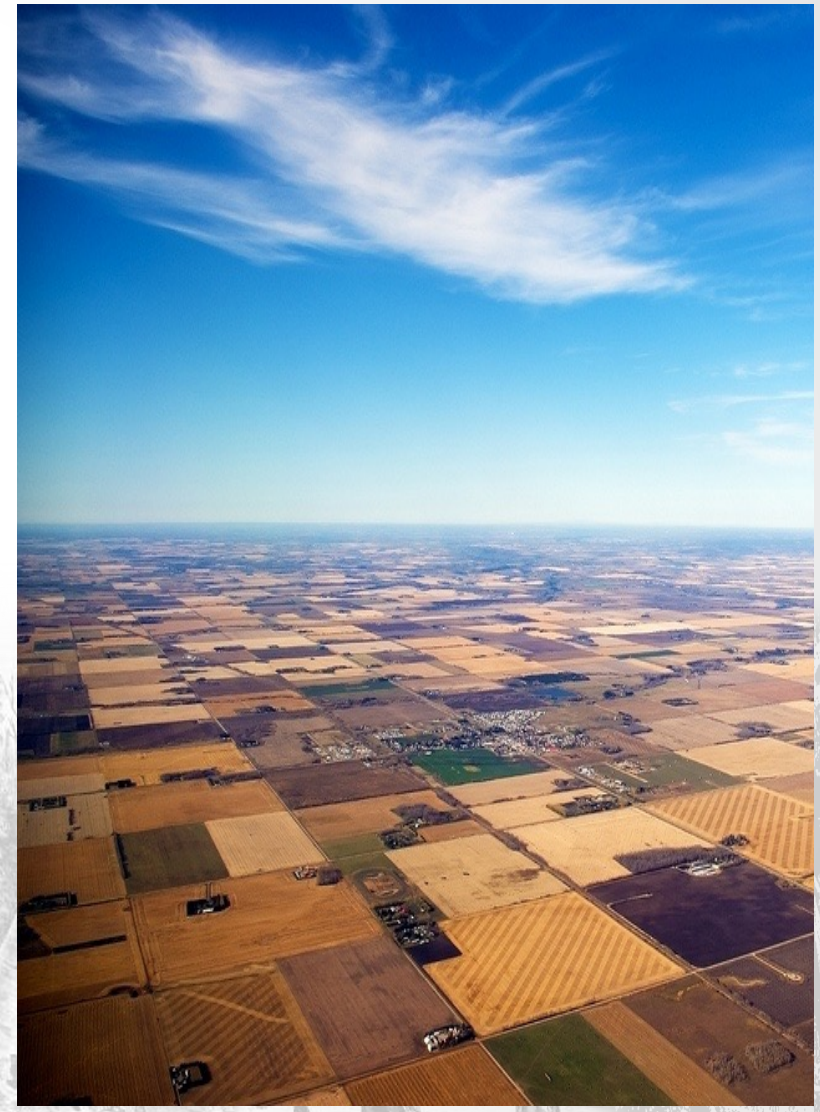




Cahokia









Pile of Bison Skulls and Bones near Saskatoon, late 1880s



The Peopling of the Plains…

The Peopling of the Plains (Recap)

- Indigenous Creation Stories – since time immemorial
- Bering Land Bridge Theory
- Pacific Coastal Migration
- For our story today – the consequences are the same regardless of when people came
- Landscape – marshy, swamps, wet, forests – not the plains we think of!
- Huge Megafauna!

Pleistocene Extinction

- Overkill hypothesis – humans entered into landscape and killed off all the large megafauna?
- Changing climate made land less inhabitable for big animals?
- What do you think sounds more convincing? Why?







Head Smashed in Buffalo Jump, Alberta



"Indians Burning the Prairie Meadows" painting by George Catlin, 1832


The Arrival of Horses in North America
France 1665
Flanders 1660
England 1629
Sweden 1629
England 1620
Spain 1493
1750
1730
1730
1770
1750
1770
1775
1719
1607
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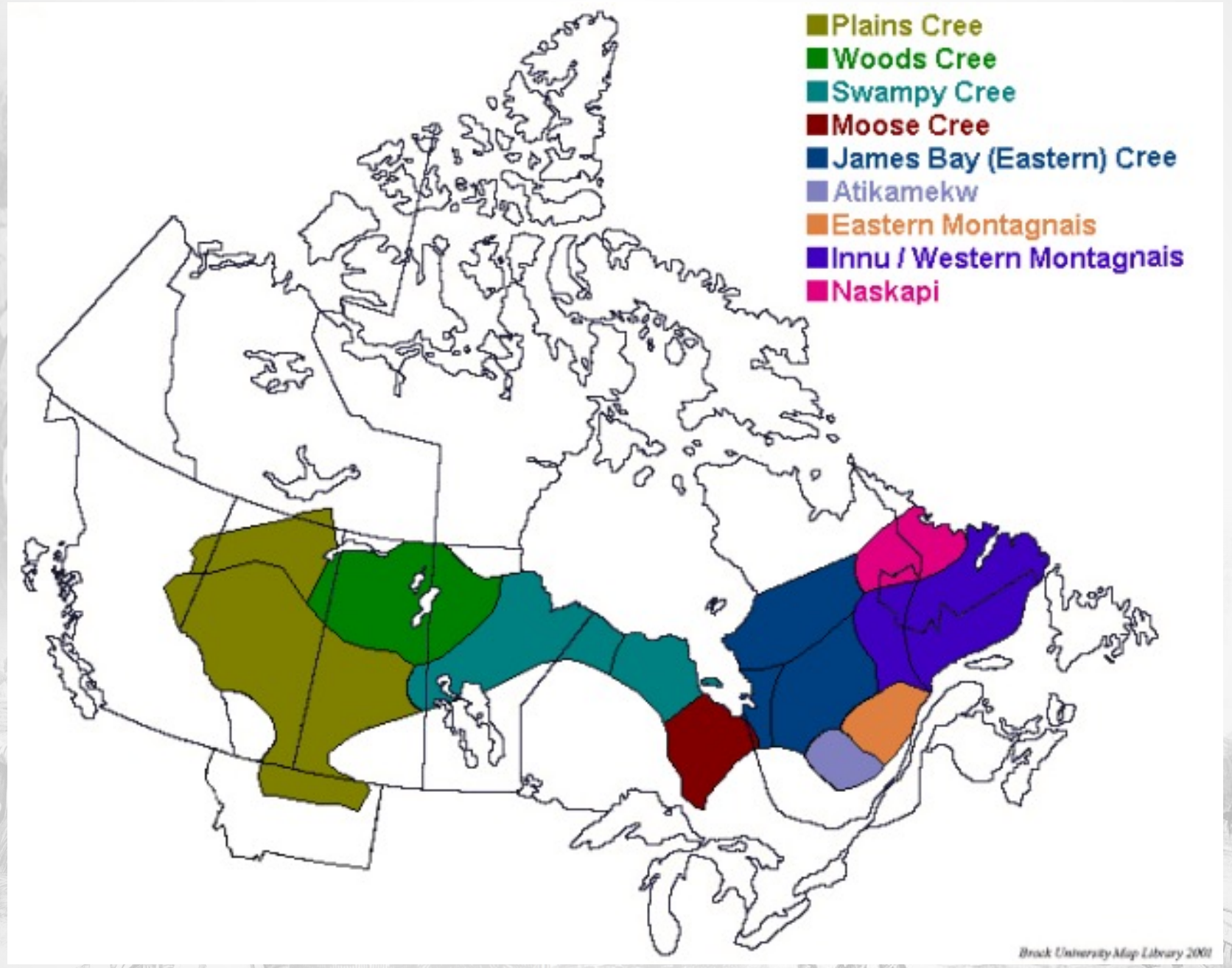


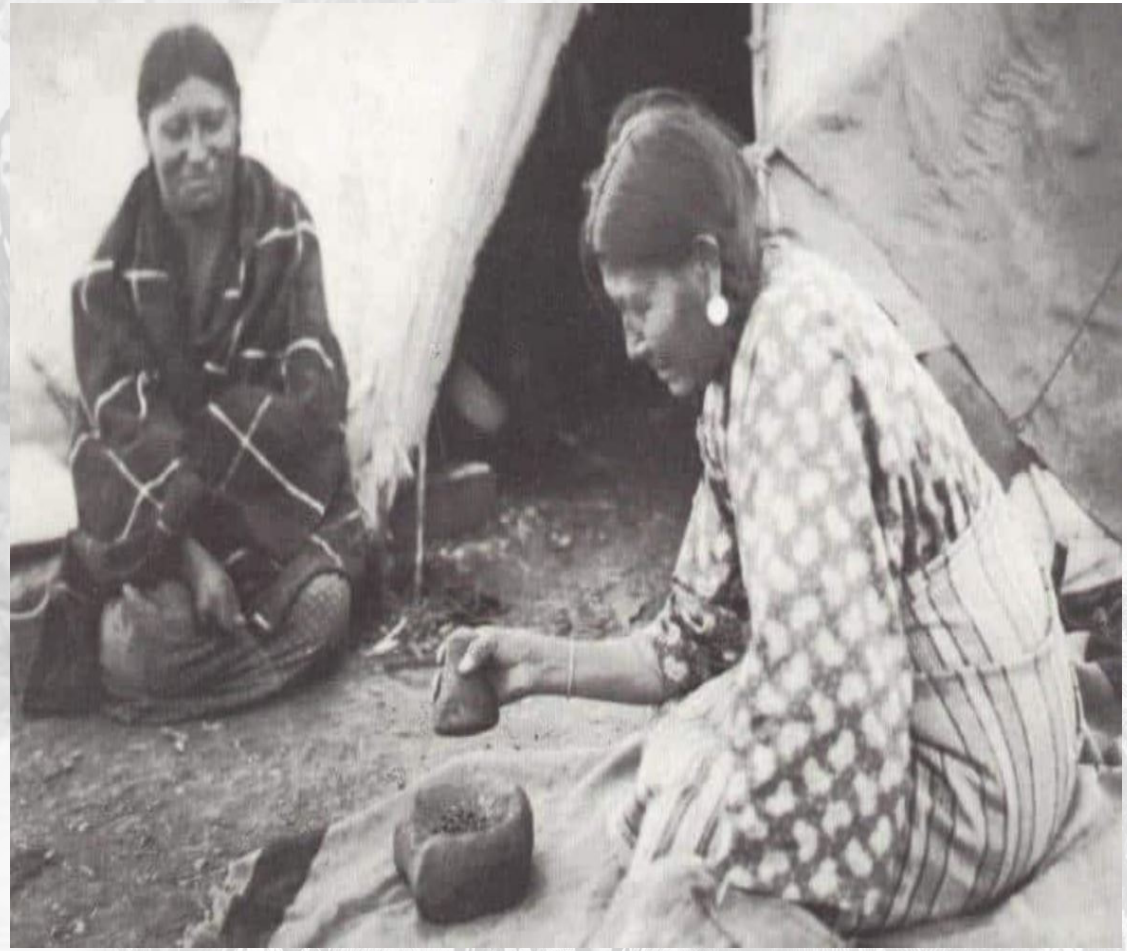
"Comanche Horsemanship", George Catlin, 1834



Mounted Empires in the North

- Horses reached northern plain by 1700
- Integrated into Plains lifeways – hunting, travel, economy, etc. – by 1750s
- Harsher climate- horse herds limited by cold/grass availibiity
- Cree Expansion from Hudson's Bay watershed
- Iron Confederacy – alliance to control flow of furs and bison products from plains to Hudson's Bay
- Ethnogenesis of the Metis (next class!)


Plains Cree
Woods Cree
Swampy Cree
Moose Cree
James Bay (Eastern) Cree
Atikamekw
Eastern Montagnais
Innu / Western Montagnais
Naskapi
Brock University Map Library 2008





Left: Pounding bison meat and fat into pemmican bricks
Right: Smoking bison meat for pemmican production

Next Class:

Guest Lecture- Introduction to the Library (Alex Liu)

Followed by Mid-Term Exam Prep Session (optional)

Primary and Secondary Sources

- **Primary Sources:** First-hand account of an event or time. Recorded by a person/people at the time an event occurred, or during the time period in question.
- **Examples:** Letters, diaries, oral history, journals, newspapers, photographs, film, paintings, survey data, pamphlets, census reports, etc.
- **Secondary Sources:** Interpretations and arguments made about the past using primary sources. They often cover the same material and topics as primary sources, but also contain the author's interpretations and inferences.
- Secondary sources mobilize primary sources to make assumptions about the past.
- **Examples:** Books, Articles, Documentaries, Academic Journals, etc.
- Remember: Secondary sources can become primary sources. For example, if you're studying the way historians writing in the 1870s understood the history of the 17th century, a secondary source textbook from the 1870s will give you insights about how historians understood 17th century history in the 1870s. This can be helpful if you are studying how knowledge has changed over time.

Evaluating Primary Sources

- Who Wrote this Document? What role or position did this person play (e.g., government official, concerned citizen)?
- Do you know for whom it was written? Or, what its intended audience was?
- Do you know, or can you guess, why the author wrote it? What might be the goal or purpose? What was the context?
- What does the source claim?
- What can you infer (conclude) from the document?

Evaluating Secondary Sources

- Many of the same things you would ask about a Primary Source-
  - Who Wrote this Document? What role or position did this person play (e.g., government official, concerned citizen)?
  - Do you know for whom it was written? Or, what its intended audience was?
  - What does the source claim?
- What evidence does the author use? Can it be validated?

Is it a good secondary source?

- Where was it published?
- What are the authors credentials?
- Does it back up claims with evidence?
- Is the information open source (i.e. Wikipedia)?
- When was it written? Has our knowledge of the topic changed? Has new information been found?
- Does it leave anything out?

Recording Important Information from Sources

- Reading Cards
  - *Author(s) Name*
  - *Title*
  - *Publishing Date*
  - *Citation info*
  - *Chronology/Geography Covered*
  - *Main Argument(s)*
  - *Conclusion(s)*
  - *Evidence Used (Oral history, diaries, letters, newspapers, etc.)*
  - *Strength of argument/limitations*
  - *How does it relate to other readings for this course/topic?*